

knows more about his money than my mate who works at ICICI and who has an MBA.

Looking at the Flipkart recruit: he scales twelve hours a day on average with his data analytics job. By weekend, he spends about 2k on leisure in and around Bangalore. In another 5 years, he sees himself getting an MBA and later scouring the globe on management consulting gigs. For Diwali and other festivities, he travels home (Jaipur) and buys his family gifts that make him the Rockstar-jaan of the family.

Currently, his modest salary of 40,000 (post tax) a month makes him the world's happiest guy. With this salary, he uses his credit card wisely, rides a new motorbike, saves for retirement, provides for his family and lavish spends on his girlfriend. He even has a monthly SIP (Systematic Investment Plan) of 10,000 invested in 3 Mutual Funds and pays his PG rent of 6,000.

To further exacerbate my frustration at his perfection, he savors food at top restaurants - his girlfriend makes a claim for an expensive Italian restaurant date every month, as her end of the bargain in the relationship.

When Pratik explained this, I had to envy him. He doesn't even shop at Big Bazaar, rather he goes to Indian Terrain showroom to buy a pair of jeans for 2000₹ . And he does it without any external help while taxes make a 20% dent in his paycheck. When someone balances so much in life with consummate ease, the hierarchical order that he assigns to his good life needed a close look. He's decisive as a fox at what he does and that's what sets him apart.

The best part about him is that anyone could adopt his money habits into their life. In fact, others could even go a step further as they live with their parents, thereby spending nothing at rent and food. Although Pratik was one of those geeks who are the envy from all sides, a common person like me can be just as successful in personal finance. Which means you too, can gorge on a couple of walnut waffles even though your ATM balance reads 145.01, knowing you've funded all the major goals in advance.

Becoming savvy